

multimedia files requires drives with quicker transfer speeds, so look for those with a USB 3.0 interface, which offer transfer rates up to 10 times faster than the preceding USB 2.0 interface. Rajesh Khurana, country manager for India and SAARC, Seagate Technology, says, "If you plan to back up frequently and your precious digital content is dispersed across your laptop, the cloud and various social media services, it can be painstaking to back it all up. You should go for drives that handle the most demanding transfer backup needs."

Portability

Portability is yet another important factor when it comes to choosing an external hard drive. The overall portability of an

external hard drive is based on factors like size, weight and durability. Many portable hard drives are just a few centimetres in size and weigh a few grams, making them lightweight, pocket-sized devices that deliver the utmost portability without sacrificing storage capacity. External hard drives are susceptible to damage. So, the durability factor plays a key role here. Your hard drive should be strong enough to withstand the minor abuse sustained in the course of daily transport and use.

Brand

Buying a well-known brand will certainly give you more bang for your bucks. The warranty will be taken care of, and you can easily get through to the company for after sales service in case of any damage.

Some of the best portable external hard drives available in the market

Seagate Backup Plus Slim

With a svelte compact design and the high-speed USB 3.0 interface, the Seagate Backup Plus Slim is a great storage solution to aggregate and back up valued photos, videos and other files, even if they are saved across numerous devices, social networks and personal computers.

It offers a slim 2 TB design, fitting into a 12.1 mm high form factor. The metal-top case of these drives, available in red, blue, black and silver, is designed to resist scratches and fingerprints.

"Seagate Backup Plus has been designed to make the chore of backing up as simple as possible. This compact, attractive external storage is hassle-free and includes Seagate Dashboard backup software for instant and easy backup of social media albums, PC content and now even mobile devices," says Rajesh Khurana.



Price:

- Backup Plus Slim portable 500 GB: ₹ 4,250
- Backup Plus Slim portable 1 TB: ₹ 6,000
- Backup Plus Slim portable 2 TB: ₹ 10,500



Price: ₹ 6,999

Dell Back-Up Plus

The Dell Back-Up Plus 1 TB hard drive gives you the luxury of storing humongous amounts of digital content in a pocket-sized device. It is equipped with amazing features like super-fast USB 3.0 connectivity. Also, since this hard drive is USB powered, it negates the need for an external power source. It is compatible with both PCs and Macs; hence, you can use the drive interchangeably on your PC or Mac computer without reformatting. It also has a sleek design.